



YOU ARE **17 WEEKS AND 5 DAYS**

156 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

This image shows how much less obvious the soft spot on the top of the baby's head has become by now. The fingers show up well here, and as your baby increases in size, it becomes easier and easier for ultrasound to show this level of detail.

“As your belly begins to grow and is more obvious, your pregnancy will become the main focus of people's attention.”

Are you getting a little more attention than you would like? Once your belly becomes very obvious, you may begin to feel that it and you are public property. Fascinated by the size of your ever-increasing abdomen, some friends and family, or even strangers, may want to see your belly, touch it, or even kiss it. This can feel very strange because, as a rule, people tend not to go around touching each other's abdomens!

If you're uncomfortable about being touched, then you could politely ask people not to touch the belly, or simply move away. There are, however, some advantages to having people notice that you are pregnant: your belly acts as a warning for people not to jostle you in crowds and people tend to give you a seat on public transportation.

Another unwanted intrusion might be that people feel entitled to ask you intimate questions regarding your medical history and about the baby. This may make you uncomfortable, especially if you tend to be a private person. People you have never met before might comment on your figure, and discuss whether you're having a girl or a boy.

Some pregnant women enjoy the attention, while others feel that people are intruding on a personal experience. If you feel uncomfortable, answer questions vaguely or try to change the subject; ask the person about him- or herself instead. Another way of avoiding the unwanted attention is to wear loose clothing that makes your belly look less prominent and attractive to touch.

SALT INTAKE

Consuming too much salt can lead to high blood pressure. It has been difficult for scientists to study salt intake in pregnancy and advise on whether it should be limited, and if so, by how much. The most sensible route is to be careful not to eat too many salty foods and add salt at the table if you need it.

ASK A DOCTOR
